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stacker news zine

STACKERS
IN THE WILD

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<Stacker News Zine>

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best posts from stacker.news

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Note from the Editor

This edition of SNZ features
stories of travel, of survival
and, could you guess,
of bitcoin.

I hope you will enjoy
spending some time
with these posts
in their artful
renderings.

Why not
tell us a
story
of
your
own?

parasite Wars:

CyberShamans



650 sats \ 10k boost \ 19 comments \
[@SHA256man](https://twitter.com/SHA256man) 19 Nov culture

top boost

WAKE UP, NEO...
THE MATRIX HAS YOU...
FOLLOW THE WHITE RABBIT.

KNOCK, KNOCK, NEO.

Wake Up Neo... - The Matrix
(1999) scene
"Neo" refers to the balanced
neocortex
(the quantum supercomputer
located between the temples);

ever since this account's creation,
the voices channeling its text messaging have been escalating
in intensity, complexity, and resolution of ideas; every shaman stands on the
shoulders of his giant predecessors (very special gratitude to [@Darthcoin](https://twitter.com/Darthcoin), [@Lux](https://twitter.com/Lux),
Mark Passio, and Satoshi); the wisdom of the eons does not accidentally sprout
into the communication realm thru one's voice; i got raised, activated, and came
online at exactly the right time, and the next voice shall carry on the One Great
Work thru *this account* or *another*;



this is not a post to preach a particular
religion; religions are various flavors of
mind-control; i already wrote about mind
control thru language and light spectrum;
mind control is everywhere, folks! u have
been fooled, falsely programmed, ever
since ur emergence from the mother's
womb; fiat money merely scratches the
surface of human enslavement dynamics;



Mark Passio.
explains the
symbols on.
the one dollar
ba'al in 35 min;
the one dollar
bill is one of the most viewed
symbols on earth; today, fiat money is
most people's #1 god;

< keep reading online >



The story you are about to read is true.

Some stackers will be kept anonymous to preserve their privacy.

I have been spending more time in the company of bitcoin people in the real world. For years I only made online connections. Now I force myself to leave the house. After a few meetups, those who show up regularly become friends. It doesn't take long to bond when you all share the same

obsession.



A bunch of us decided at a dinner last week that we would plan a trip to PubKey. Erik Cason was scheduled to appear as the featured guest soon, and we were all fans, so four of us decided to car pool to see him. I was thankful for that, because making that long drive at night is getting tougher as I get older.

We all met at the driver's house in the middle of the afternoon. Pub Key events usually start at 6:00pm, and we had a long journey ahead of us. The driver showed us around his beautiful home. After everyone arrived, he directed us to a Tesla parked in the driveway. I'm not a Tesla expert, but from what I can tell it was an older model 3. Our host/driver explained that the car drove him home from last week's dinner without him having to control the car in any way. I was impressed.

He then told us that tonight would be the real test.

Let's see if it could drive us to PubKey by itself. Now, keep in mind that the self driving system we would use is not the latest, state of the art system you would find in a new Tesla.



Also keep in mind that we would be driving for a substantial part of our journey on the Long Island Expressway, during rush hour, on a weekday. For those who don't have personal knowledge of this road, known regionally as the LIE, [here](#) are a few fun facts. To summarize, the "expressway" was obsolete before it was completed in the early 1960s. Construction, lane closures, furious drivers, horrible car accidents. The LIE has them all. Most famously, singer songwriter Harry Chapin was killed on the LIE back in the early 1980s. I hate the LIE. Everyone hates the LIE. The Tesla would be challenged. Of that I had no doubt. If we survived the first part of the journey, we would be rewarded with a crawl through the carbon monoxide filled Midtown Tunnel. There was a time, decades ago, when I would notice a lane closure on the roadway approaching the tunnel. Now, lanes seem permanently closed, even though those temporary plastic cones would have us believe otherwise. Once through the tunnel, we could enjoy a slow, gridlocked crawl down to Greenwich Village.

I climbed into the back seat. I still think it's pretty damn cool to sit in a Tesla. I have only been in a few over the years. The roof of the car was clear glass. I gazed up at the sky. We settled in and planned the evening. Then, we were all almost killed. It was only a minute or two into the trip. Am I exaggerating? Maybe a little, but it was not a great start. We were chatting away, including the "driver", when we all realized, at the same moment, that the Tesla had decided to follow a non existent lane. We came close to smashing into a cement wall at a pretty decent speed. Our driver grabbed the wheel and saved us all. In the moment, it was fun. I think I made a joke about tomorrow's headline: **"Four men killed in a self driving Tesla while on their way to PubKey."**

The fun was just starting. Conversation inside the vehicle turned to the therapeutic benefits of hallucinogenic mushrooms. As various strains (is it really called penis envy?) were discussed, the Tesla decided to merge quickly onto the LIE without fully taking into account the traffic and speed of the other vehicles. Once again, our host saved the day by wresting control of the wheel from the robot brain.

continue reading
on the next page
or go to pubkey >>



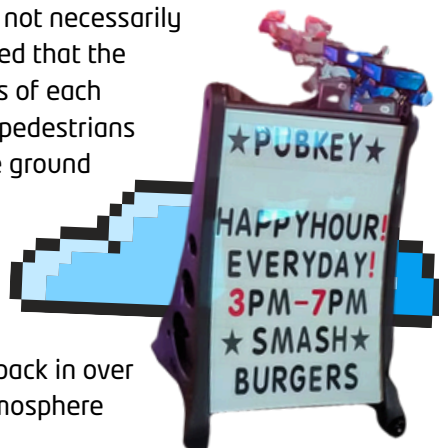
< continued >



The conversation continued. I have to admit that based upon the general enthusiasm of my fellow travelers, I wondered how many of them (all?) were in fact enjoying a few grams of mushrooms at that very moment. I silently hoped that our driver had not indulged. We needed him to have his full wits about him. I watched him, relaxed and smiling, as he turned full around in his seat to make a point. Was I in the presence of bitcoin's Neal Cassady? Meanwhile, the Tesla didn't realize that a truck cab had a lengthy trailer attached. That long low beast was only feet away from the front of our car when our host again came to the rescue. We all laughed.

We drove along the LIE for about an hour. The conversation was very enjoyable. I don't want to give the impression that all we talked about was mushrooms. We also discussed weed, gambling, and bitcoin, but not necessarily in that order. When we got to the city we noticed that the car's screen monitor not only showed depictions of each vehicle in the surrounding area, but the human pedestrians as well. I wondered if they would lie flat on the ground if we hit one.

The drive took longer than we expected. We found a spot on the street well within walking distance of PubKey. I had not been back in over a year, so I took some time to absorb the atmosphere when we walked in. ***I love the place.***



As usual, there were plenty of drinkers at the bar. PubKey is a thriving local watering hole, so the front area is usually packed with normies who wouldn't know Satoshi from Sasquatch. In the back were all the bitcoiners. I bought the first round and told the bartender I wanted to pay with bitcoin. He ran a tab. As usual, I was the only one paying with bitcoin. Whenever I pay with bitcoin I can sense the derision of my fellow stackers. They can't believe I would spend my precious sats when I have the opportunity to get rid of crappy fiat instead. There were screens displaying the bitcoin price everywhere. It just so happened that we picked a night when the btc price was "crashing" under 100K fiat. The few bitcoiners around the bar were noticing. Hearing a few conversations made it seem almost like play by play at a sporting event. "It's going up!!!" "OH NO, it went back down." "But, it's going back up again!" I wanted to slam my Guinness pint on the bar and scream "One bitcoin equals one bitcoin, muthaf*ckers!", but instead I just sipped my beer.



We had all met before at various meetups. If you're not familiar with him, check out this podcast. He told me about his new project, where he wants to establish an organization to fund the arts with bitcoin. It sounded like a great idea.

Tom Pacchia, one of the owners and the public face of [@pubkey](#), stopped by to greet us. You might remember him as the guy who sold Trump a burger for bitcoin during the campaign. He mentioned that he had just completed a podcast with Erik Cason in the studio above the bar, and he recommended that we give it a listen.

Soon all of the bitcoiners headed to the back room, while the oblivious locals continued to drink at the front bar. When I got back there, the only bitcoiner I recognized was Surfer Jim. One of the perks of getting away from the keyboard and attending bitcoin events is the wonderful people you meet. Surfer Jim and [@ProofOfWorkFitness](#) are two shining examples. The former even has a song praising his glories.

Erik Cason gave a great talk, as I expected. [Here](#) is the recording of the live event. <<



read where
the saga ends
next >>

When it was over we hung around outside PubKey for a while. Then the group decided to get some pizza at

John's Of Bleeker Street.

John's has been open since before the Great Depression, and it serves some of the best pizza in New York City. We had to wait on line outside for a while. I was getting cold and tired. My ability to keep up with my younger compatriots started flagging. Nowadays I can only have so much fun before I pass out. I didn't even get my afternoon nap. After the pizza we walked back to the car. I guess I seemed a bit worse for wear at that point, since our host and part time driver offered to let me sit in the back seat of the Tesla while they continued the party a little while longer. It was time to put Grandpa Siggy to bed. I eagerly accepted the offer. It occurred to me that if the festivities continued into the wee hours of the morning, I might be called upon to serve as the group's Oscar Acosta, but luckily our Raul Duke and his friends didn't encounter any law enforcement.

Eventually

we began the return journey. I remember bits and pieces of the conversation at the beginning of the ride, but soon I fell asleep. I have no idea how close to death I may have come while I was unconscious. When I woke up we had arrived at our original meeting place.

**It was just another night
on the road
to a new bitcoin world.**

a commenter
has this
to say >>

92 sats \ 2 replies \ @Coinsreporter 15 Nov

This place is amazing. I've started to wish we had something similar here! And btw a nicely written piece, just read from word one till last without skipping.

< continued >
again



top post

The chocolate coins inside the Bank of Japan

3142 sats \ 14 comments \ @chungkingexpress 18 Nov bitcoin

I toured the Bank of Japan recently with another Bitcoin buddy. It took many months to get on the waiting list. It was a surreal experience of windowless corridors, giant paintings of all the governors as if they were kings, and a quirky lecture on the primary roles of the central bank.

The emptiness and banality of it all was quite striking. The sense of unease, paranoia, and secrecy that permeated every corner of the building was palpable.

There were only a few places where we were allowed to take photographs. The old governor's office high up on the third floor had internal "windows" to look over the rest of the building like a panopticon prison.

Perhaps the most ironic bit, which was in all earnestness, were the ridiculous chocolate "gold coins" in the visitor centre and the teeny-tiny baggie of shredded Japanese yen bills that we were given as a thank you at the end.

It is hard to even mock or laugh at such a performance because it was done in such unashamed seriousness.

This is it.

This is what Bitcoin is going to replace. On a visual level, as well as a conceptual one, there is a legacy system of empire and emperors that exist behind the cloistered veil of the institution of Central Banking. But by pulling back the curtain, or in this case, being welcomed inside for a tour, reveals that indeed the emperor has no clothes.



LIVING - SURVIVING

top
post



in Venezuela

3090 sats \ 21 comments \ @bief57 19 Nov culture

My stay here lasted longer than I initially thought. I have to accept that I have privileges that, without them, would really complicate things a lot more.

- 1- I'm not paying rent (for now).
- 2- I'm generating income in Bitcoin (not as much as I'd like, for now, but enough to cover some expenses).
- 3- Support from my close family.

There is no shortage of food, and I pray to God that it will not happen again.

In the municipality where I am, they ration the water. From Monday to Friday, there is no water from 1:30 pm to 6:30 pm. On Saturday and Sunday, there is water all day. If people don't want to be so affected by this, they solve the problem by having tanks to store water. Since the water that comes to my house is from a well, it works with a pump, which means that when there is no electricity there is also no water, because the pump runs on electricity. These rationing measures can be nonexistent or worse depending on the location.

The electricity, in the first 4 months that I have been here, the power only went out about 4 or 5 times a month, for an hour and a couple of times for 5 hours.

For the last 2 months, the electricity has been going out every other day, that is, one day on and one day off for 4 continuous hours.

What do people do to counteract the discomfort of not having electricity? Those with a better economic position opt for solar panels or electric generators (these are the ones that some businesses usually have).

What do people do to counteract the discomfort of not having electricity? Those with a better economic position opt for solar panels or electric generators (these are the ones that some businesses usually have).

In my case, we can't afford solar panels yet because they're expensive, but we opted for rechargeable light bulbs, rechargeable fans because it gets very hot here and there are too many mosquitoes, power banks for our phones, and finally, something I didn't know about until I got here: mini UPS units to keep the router running when there's no electricity. In fact, I'm posting this right now while I don't have electricity at home.

Domestic cooking gas [#997415](#) and gasoline [#970475](#) are two other headaches; here are some posts I made about them.

For times when there's no gas, we have a backup electric stove, air fryer, electric griddle, electric rice cooker, and any other appliance that can cook with electricity. If you have neither electricity nor gas, then you're just out of luck, and with a bit of luck, you might be able to buy bread.

Public health is the same or worse than when I emigrated several years ago.

The salaries are absurd. This topic deserves a lengthy post.

In conclusion, we all maneuver as best we can to alleviate the discomforts and disadvantages of living here.



Edit:

An absurd comment I read on X



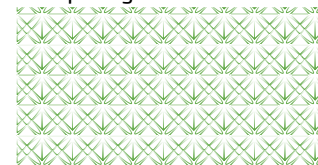
< comments >

< *It's because of bitcoin farms like this that they cut off our electricity in Venezuela so that a few cronies can profit at the expense of the Venezuelan people's needs.*

289 sats \ 2 replies \ @Undisciplined 19 Nov

Like most of us, I've thought about how much more beneficial bitcoin will be for people in places like where you are than places like where I am, but this post made me realize the same is true for home power generation.

I've been thinking about solar panels for a while, but they don't solve a real problem for me because we have reliable electricity. It only goes out a few times a year and not usually when there's much sunlight. Solar panels would mostly just reduce our electricity bill, which makes them a purely financial decision.



55 sats \ 1 reply \ @d680ecaa8e 20 Nov
It could be hard life but things are manageable.

→ 0 sats \ 0 replies \ @bief57 OP 20 Nov

That's right. Besides, everyone's situation is different. There are people who live here and don't seem to be affected at all, while there are also people who have found it really difficult to get by.

Meme Monday - Best Bitcoin Meme Gets 5,000 CCs

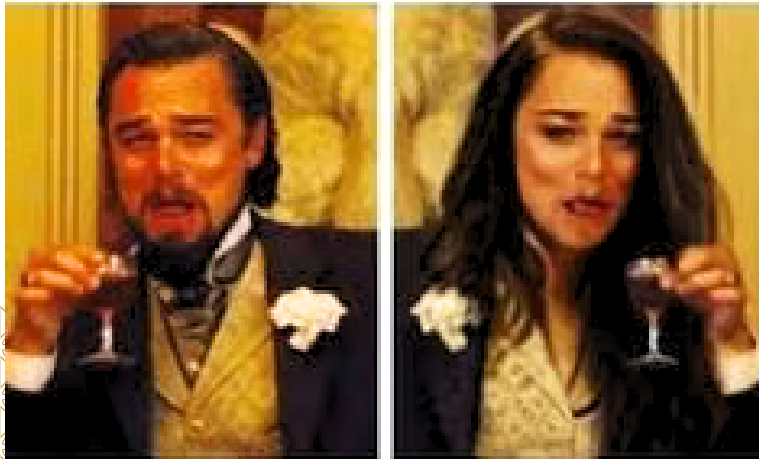
365 sats \ 31 comments \ @sn 17 Nov memes



5036 sats \ 1 reply \ @para 17 Nov

< winner >

**WHEN YOU BOTH HAVE
THE SAME VIEWS ON BITCOIN**

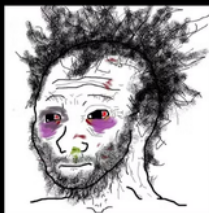


honorable
mentions

1 sat \ 0 replies \ @Kontext 17 Nov

**WHEN YOUR
BANK ACCOUNT IS EMPTY**

**AS A
NORMAL PERSON**

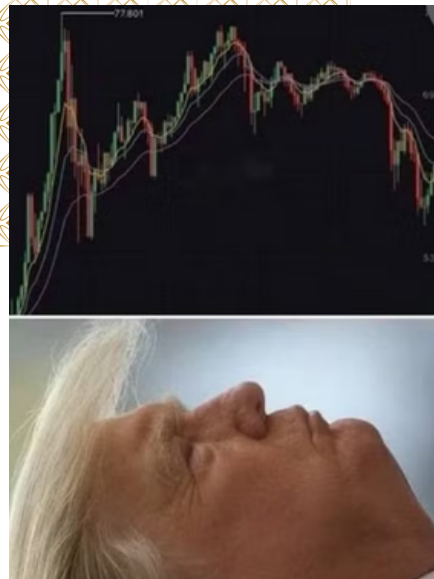


**AS A
BITCOINER**



KONTEXT

1 sat \ 0 replies \ @Akg10s3 17 Nov



top post



it's a stablecoin pegged to bitcoin

4669 sats \ 14 comments \ @Scoresby 19 Nov bitcoin

The more people who use bitcoin, the less useful it becomes

This may not sound right to you, but let's think it through: in order to use bitcoin (even if your use case is hodling in cold storage) you need to acquire bitcoin. This means someone must make a transaction that transfers bitcoin to you and this transaction must be confirmed in a block on the chain with the most proof of work.

In order to do that, someone is going to have to pay a transaction fee. It doesn't matter if you are buying bitcoin from a stranger in an alley or from a kyc'd exchange, the fee must come from the sender. But it's likely they will pass that fee on as a cost to you.

Clearly, there are fee rates at which it no longer makes sense for you to buy the amount of bitcoin you were planning on buying. Because bitcoin fees are not based on the number of sats transferred, but the number of bytes required by the transaction, you might decide to wait to make your purchase of bitcoin until you can buy more sats. There may even be a fee level at which you decide it's not worth it to buy bitcoin at all.

Bitcoin is unique among moneys for this property that it costs more to use as more people try to use it.

What stops somebody from just copying the code and starting another bitcoin?

When something gets expensive in a free market, there is an incentive for people to make an alternative that is cheaper.

One of the earliest (and most unthoughtful) gotchas people have thrown at Bitcoin is that since the code is open source "there's no reason somebody can't just start a new one."

While it is true that many people have started new coins, it's also become clear why this doesn't work very well: Bitcoin has a massive infrastructure built around it (hash rate, wallets and other tools, lightning, and a well developed network of users) and any new coin that wants to fulfill a similar utility -- even as a cheaper substitute -- has to overcome very high startup costs.

It's not very easy to jumpstart a new coin. This is why so many altcoins are shitcoins.

< continued >

If things like Ark, Spark, Liquid, and ecash aren't BTC, they must be altcoins

We've all struggled with describing the new payment solutions that have been showing up in Bitcoin the last few years. Mostly, I've seen people comparing them to Lightning: calling them layer twos and talking about how they have slightly different trust assumptions.

For instance, it is clear that ecash has no unilateral exit to bitcoin -- if the mint doesn't want to give you bitcoin for your ecash tokens, there's really nothing you can do about it.

Spark has the possibility of unilateral exit to bitcoin -- but only if you have enough bitcoin to pay the on chain fees and leave yourself with a worthwhile UTXO. And if you want to use it with Lightning, it seems like you are trusting the channel owner at some point. Ark is similar.

These trade-offs have led to a lot of confusion: is a vUTXO the same as bitcoin? Are sats in Spark the same as sats on Lightning?

I wonder if we wouldn't do a better job of explaining these things and understanding them ourselves if we just called them altcoins and accepted that they are a market response to the cost of transacting on bitcoin.

Stablecoins pegged to bitcoin

Except, they aren't *just* altcoins -- ecash tokens are supposed to have the same value as sats and the same goes for vUTXOs in Ark. So, really, what we are working with is a stablecoin that is pegged to bitcoin.

Like a stablecoin issuer, mint operators and Spark entities are promising to "back" the tokens they give you with bitcoin at a 1 to 1 ratio. You have some assurances that this will be the case (indeed, much better than the assurances afforded by stablecoins that attempt to be pegged to fiat currencies), but it's not a guarantee.

Does this apply to Lightning?

I don't think so. Lightning duplicates most of the assurances of bitcoin. In order to use Lightning, you need to open a channel. Anyone can open a channel, and in opening a channel, you have strong protections to get your sats back onchain.

To use ecash or Ark or Spark, you don't have to run a mint or an ark or a Spark entity -- but this also means that there is a fundamental difference between these things and Lightning: we've shifted from a permissionless protocol to a permissioned protocol.

I've been reading [Cryptoeconomics](#) again, and this is an attempt to work through some of the ideas in the chapter called "Substitution Principle" [which you might read by following this post's QR].

territory highlight

~econ FOREVER



2885 sats \ 43 comments \ @Undisciplined 17 Nov econ

I just purchased ~econ in full!
As long as @k00b keeps the lights on, this will be a place to discuss all things Human Action.

